



THE AI GOLD RUSH

894 indie startups, ranked by real revenue. *One governing insight.*

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

AI is the most crowded category in this dataset — and it converts founders to real revenue at a below-average rate

19%

of all startups are AI

Nearly 3x SaaS, the next-largest category

19.1%

of AI founders reach \$10K+ MRR

vs. 23.3% pooled average elsewhere

58%

of AI revenue held by top 5 of 173 firms

Winner-take-most, not broad-based

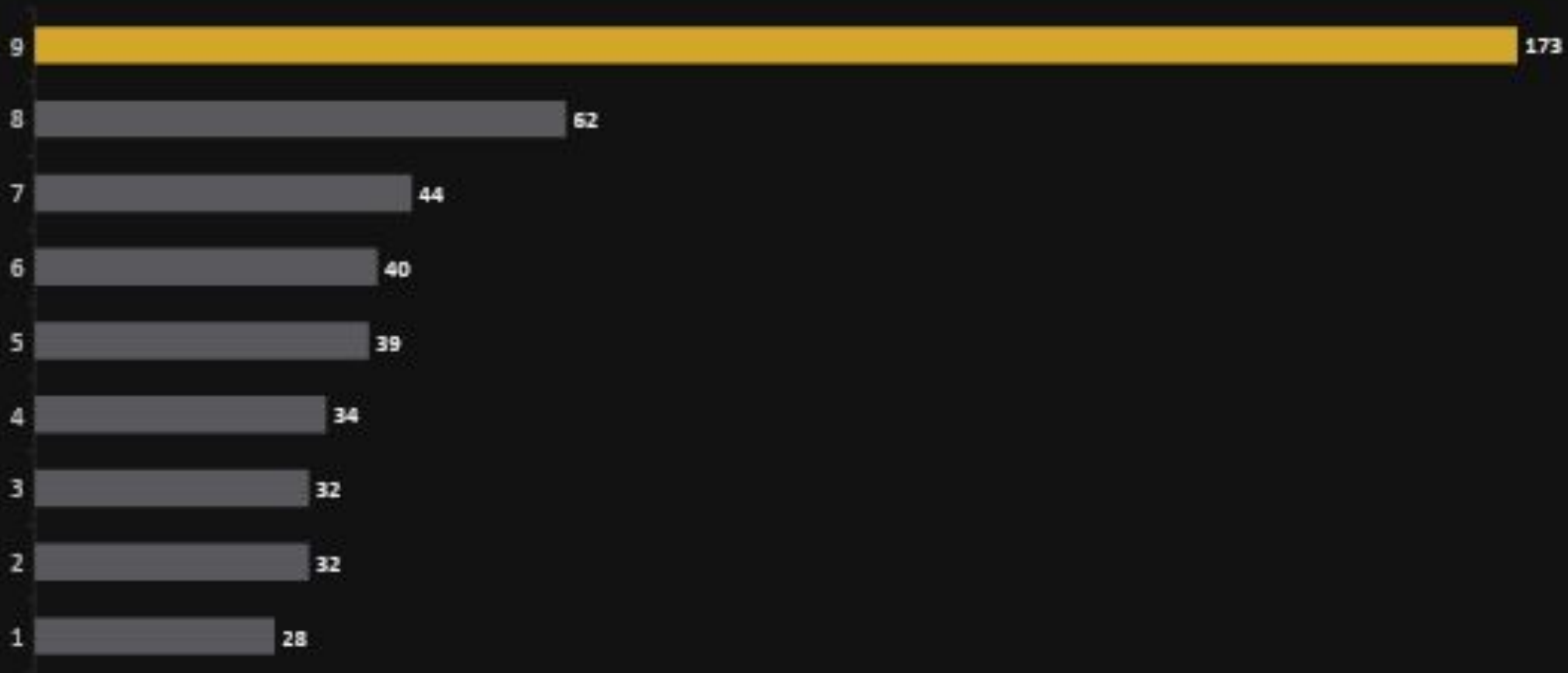
0.0%

AI's median 30-day MRR growth

Flat — same as most other categories

AI accounts for 1 in 5 startups — nearly 3x the next-largest category

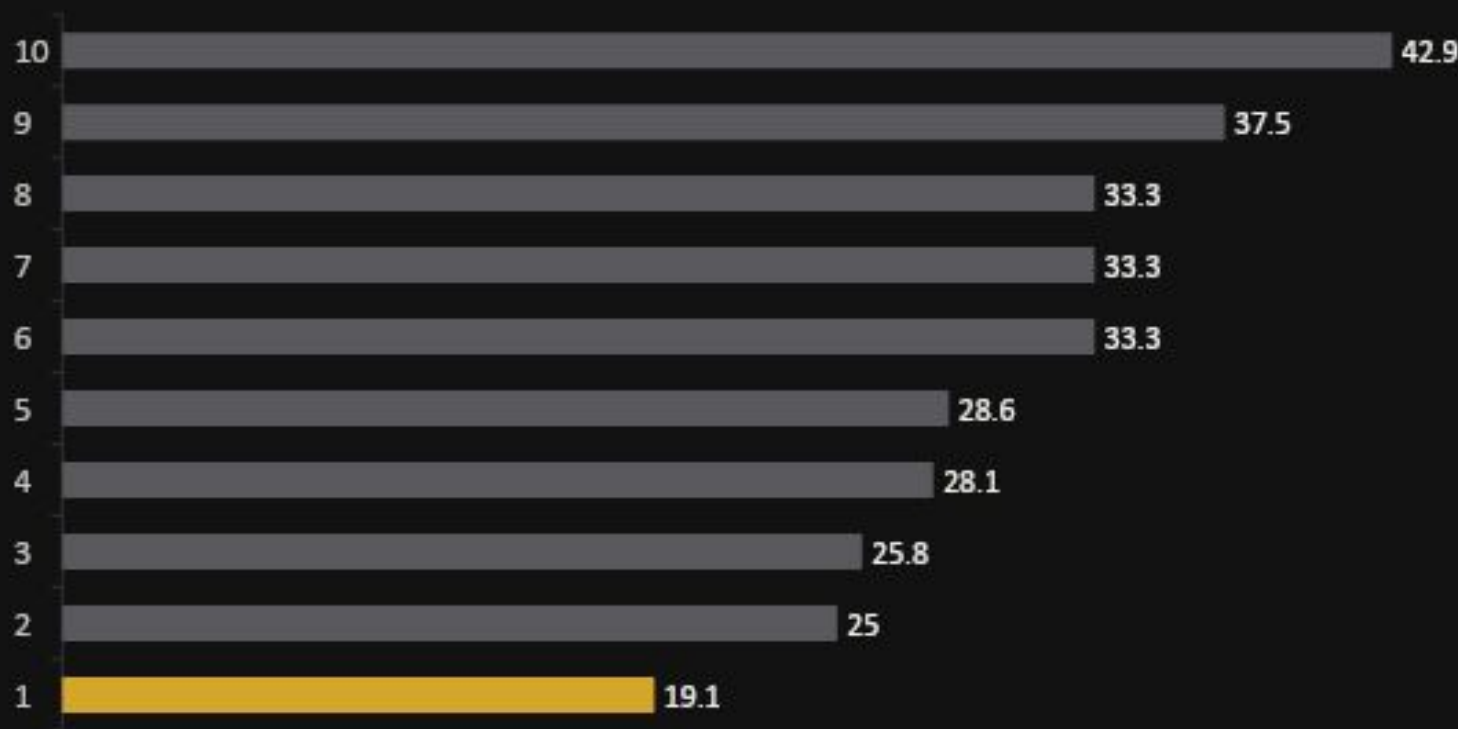
Startup count by category (n = 894)



AI's \$10K+ MRR hit rate (19.1%) trails the pooled average across every other category (23.3%)

Share of founders reaching \$10K+ MRR, by category

Categories shown are the 10 highest hit-rate categories (n≥8) for context. AI's benchmark is the pooled average of all 721 non-AI founders, not this subset.



173

AI competitors in this dataset

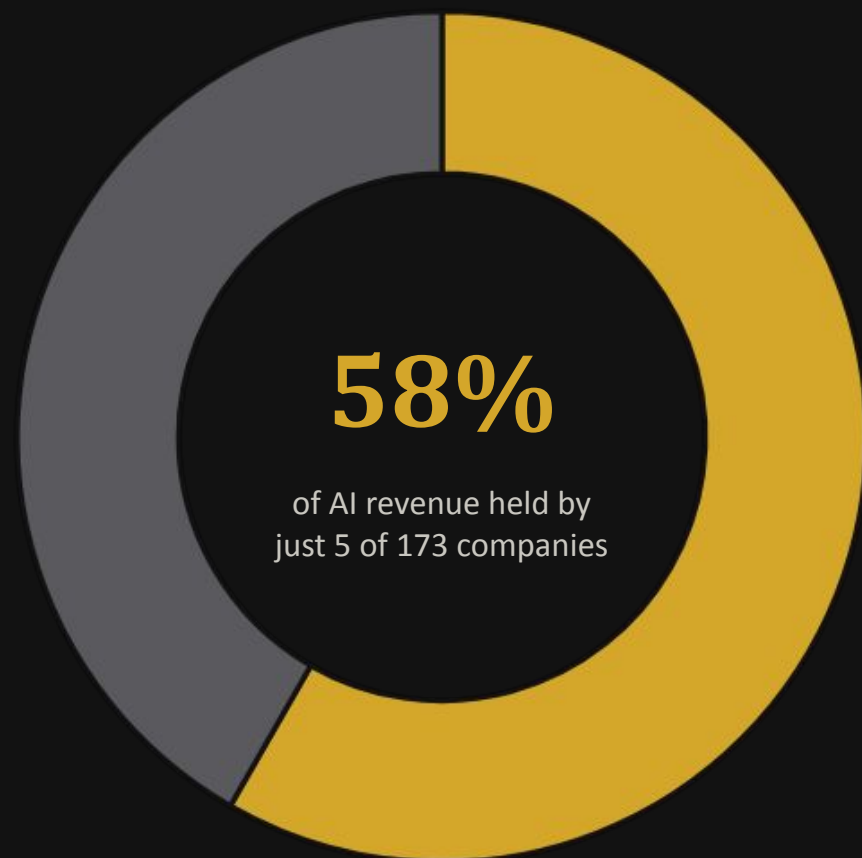
23.3%

pooled hit-rate across every other category (721 founders)

Categories under 15 companies (Games, Analytics, Sales) are directionally indicative, not statistically definitive.

Even inside AI, 3% of companies hold 58% of category revenue

Where the AI category's \$1.75M in monthly revenue actually sits

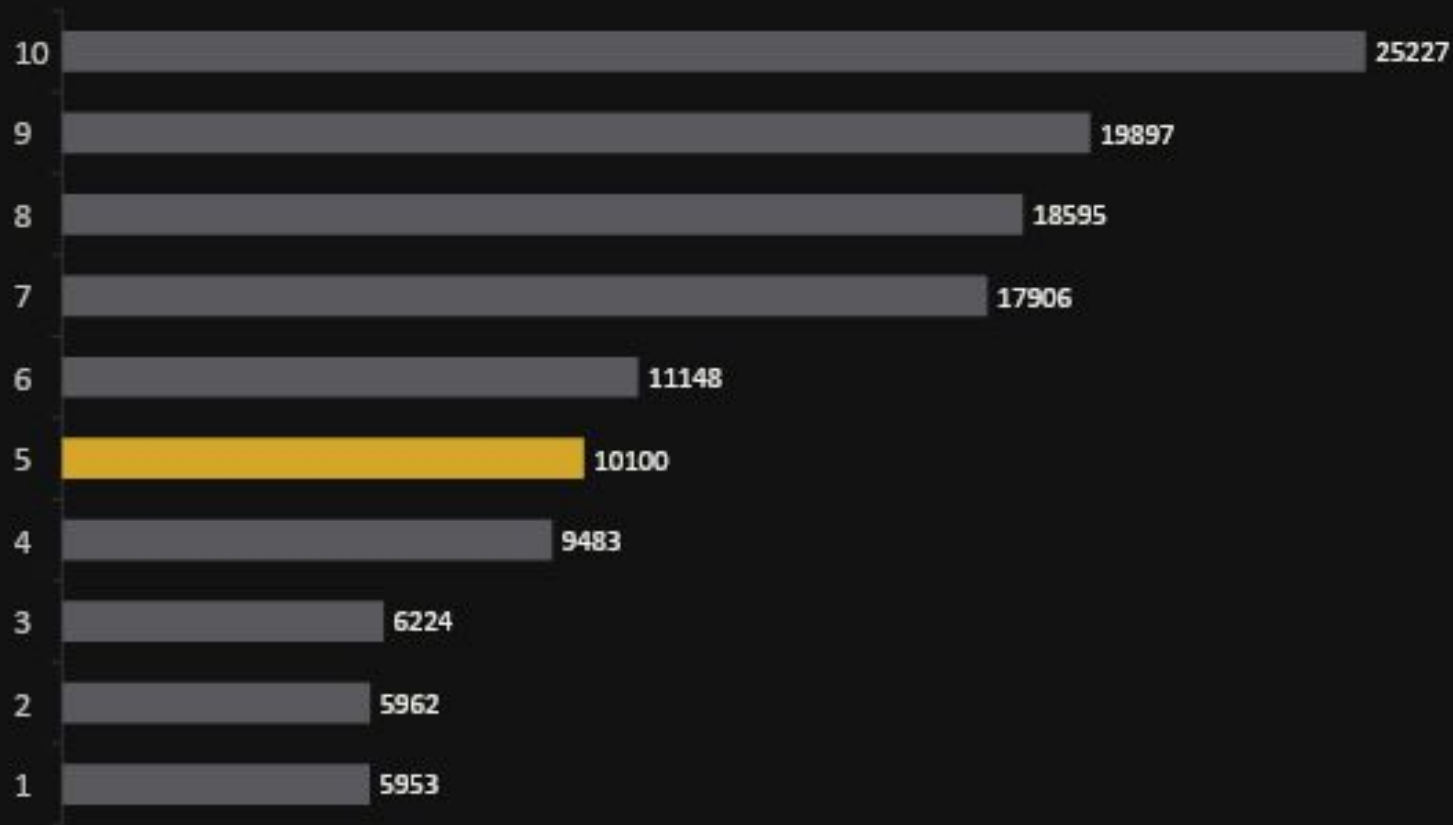


GojiberryAI	\$494,668 /mo
Rezi	\$259,701 /mo
PROSP	\$128,005 /mo
Upscale System LLC	\$86,543 /mo
SEOBOT	\$49,691 /mo
Remaining 168 companies	avg \$4,338 /mo

Company names and figures as self-reported by founders on TrustMRR (public listings).

AI's average founder revenue (\$10.1K/mo) trails the pooled non-AI average (\$15.8K/mo)

Average monthly recurring revenue per founder, by category (n ≥ 8) — five categories exceed AI's average



\$10,100

avg. monthly revenue per AI founder

\$15,807

pooled average, all other categories (721 founders)

The obvious rebuttal — “AI is just early” — doesn't hold in this snapshot

Median 30-day MRR growth by category

0.0%

AI's median 30-day MRR growth

Identical to SaaS, Mobile Apps, Productivity, Marketing, Content Creation, Health & Fitness, and Education

8 of 9

major categories are flat at 0% growth

Only Dev Tools shows positive median growth this period (+8.0%)

If AI were still ramping, growth would show it. It doesn't — yet.

8 of 9 major categories show exactly 0% median growth — this may reflect reporting lag in self-tracked MRR rather than confirmed stagnation. Treat as directional, not definitive.

IMPLICATION

“AI” is not a category to bet on — it’s a label to diligence past.

19% crowded · 19.1% hit rate (vs. 23.3% pooled) · 58% held by 5 firms · 0.0% growth

FOR INVESTORS

Before funding any 'AI' startup, verify it clears the category's own \$10.1K/mo average per founder — not just its growth narrative.

Underwrite for winner-take-most: assume long odds of top-5 economics, and price the round accordingly.

FOR BUILDERS

Entering AI means targeting a top-tier outcome — the median AI company earns \$614/mo, far below the \$10.1K average.

Analytics, e-commerce, education, social media, and marketing carry a fraction of AI's competition and higher average founder revenue (\$11K–\$25K/mo).